

Beliefs about Refugee Integration in Germany: A Survey Experiment on Ukrainian and Syrian Refugees

Master Thesis Presented to the
Department of Economics at the
Rheinische Friedrich-Wilhelms-Universität Bonn

In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Degree of
Master of Science (M.Sc.)

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Florian Zimmermann

Submitted in September 2026 by

Lidiia Levytska
Matriculation Number: 50274891

Contents

1	Introduction	1
2	Related Literature	1
2.1	Attitudes Towards Refugees	1
2.2	Belief Formation	1
2.3	Contact Theory	1
2.4	Experience and Memory	1
2.5	Media Exposure	1
3	Conceptual Framework	1
3.1	Beliefs About Refugee Integration	1
3.2	Channels of Belief Formation	1
3.3	Hypotheses	1
4	Experimental Design	1
4.1	Survey Design	1
4.2	Vignette Experiment	1
4.3	Outcome Variables	1
4.4	Questionnaire	1
5	Empirical Strategy	1
5.1	Main Specification	1
5.2	Heterogeneity Analysis	1
6	Discussion	1
6.1	Limitations	1
6.2	Future Research	1
	References	2

1 Introduction

2 Related Literature

2.1 Attitudes Towards Refugees

2.2 Belief Formation

2.3 Contact Theory

2.4 Experience and Memory

2.5 Media Exposure

3 Conceptual Framework

3.1 Beliefs About Refugee Integration

3.2 Channels of Belief Formation

3.3 Hypotheses

4 Experimental Design

4.1 Survey Design

4.2 Vignette Experiment

4.3 Outcome Variables

4.4 Questionnaire

5 Empirical Strategy

5.1 Main Specification

5.2 Heterogeneity Analysis

6 Discussion

6.1 Limitations

6.2 Future Research

References

Statement of Authorship

I hereby confirm that the work presented has been performed and interpreted solely by myself except for where I explicitly identified the contrary. I assure that this work has not been presented in any other form for the fulfillment of any other degree or qualification. Ideas taken from other works in letter and in spirit are identified in every single case.

Date:

Signature: